

# Edward Spaay

Infrastructure Security Compliance | OS Hardening | CIS, NIST, STIG | Endpoint & Compliance Leadership

Sykesville, MD | US Citizen | [nebet52@outlook.com](mailto:nebet52@outlook.com) | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/edwards-engineer/> | <https://github.com/yaa194098-tech/EdwardS>

## Executive Profile

- Security architect-minded senior engineer with 18 years in cybersecurity specializing in OS hardening, enterprise security baselines, compliance engineering, and vulnerability remediation. Known for leading control implementation across nine technologies, partnering with Enterprise Security and infrastructure leadership, and driving measurable improvements in audit readiness and security posture.
- Expert in Windows hardening, Active Directory / Group Policy, endpoint and server configuration management, Tenable and Wiz reporting, ServiceNow workflows, and macOS hardening. Design and implement hardening standards for cloud and datacenter platforms; define controls and baselines across the technology stack; and establish reporting and oversight mechanisms to provide clear visibility into security posture.

## Target Roles

- Infrastructure Security w/ GPO management
- Security engineer
- Enterprise Security
- Endpoint Security
- Infrastructure Security

## SELECTED IMPACT

|                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>9 technologies</b><br>Led security control implementation and hardening across nine enterprise technologies in a regulated environment.         | <b>100% compliance</b><br>Drove and sustained full adherence to defined CIS / NIST / STIG-aligned control requirements through standardization and remediation workflows. |
| <b>~30% risk reduction</b><br>Reduced high-risk vulnerability exposure by roughly 30% using Tenable, Wiz, prioritization, and tracked remediation. | <b>SSA recognition</b><br>Received the SSA Associate Commissioner's Citation for rapid Microsoft Critical Alert assessment and deployment support.                        |

## CORE EXPERTISE

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Security &amp; Architecture 18 yrs</b><br>Infrastructure security, OS hardening, security baselines, security architecture, enterprise control implementation, least privilege, privileged access, audit readiness | <b>Platforms &amp; Identity 18 yrs</b><br>Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy, domain controllers, endpoint security, macOS hardening       |
| <b>Compliance Frameworks 18 yrs</b><br>CIS Benchmarks, NIST, DISA STIG, FISMA, policy-aligned hardening, remediation governance                                                                                       | <b>Tools &amp; Workflow 9+ yrs</b><br>Tenable.sc, Tenable.io, Wiz, ServiceNow, vulnerability management, documentation authoring, remediation tracking |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### MissionSquare Retirement | Washington, DC

Senior Engineer, Infrastructure Configuration | Jan 2016 – 2026

- Led hardening and compliance engineering across nine technologies, aligning implementations to CIS, NIST, DISA STIG, and internal security requirements.
- Architected and enforced AD/GPO security baselines for critical Windows infrastructure (including ~10 domain controllers), strengthening least privilege and configuration governance.
- Standardized security baselines, operational guidance, and remediation workflows to achieve and sustain 100% compliance for targeted control requirements.
- Operationalized Tenable.sc/Tenable.io and Wiz reporting to prioritize remediation and reduce high-risk vulnerability exposure by ~30%.
- Integrated ServiceNow with vulnerability and compliance workflows so findings were assigned, tracked, documented, and audit-ready through closure.
- macOS hardening SME (6 years): authored standards and service-desk runbooks supporting secure configuration for business users.
- Produced security standards and implementation documentation that improved consistency, supportability, and audit readiness across engineering and support teams.

### Social Security Administration (SSA) | Senior Engineering

Senior Security Engineer (Contractor, Multiple Roles) | Feb 1999 – Mar 2014

- Supported SSA security engineering initiatives for 14+ years and was repeatedly kept across follow-on contracts based on performance, delivery, and domain knowledge in a fast-moving federal environment.
- Engineered AD / GPO-driven security architecture for Windows environments covering approximately 100,000 servers across 12 federal domains.
- Implemented and supported CIS / NIST / FISMA / DISA STIG-aligned configuration baselines that standardized secure server builds across 19 enterprise data centers.
- Helped achieve and sustain full coverage of targeted CIS-aligned controls across a large-scale, highly regulated server estate.
- Built patching and remediation workflows that reduced high-risk vulnerability exposure by roughly 30% and strengthened audit outcomes.
- Led Microsoft Critical Alert Team patch deployment efforts, coordinating rapid assessment and rollout of critical Microsoft updates across SSA server infrastructure.
- Received the 2005 SSA Associate Commissioner's Citation for critical support helping assure rapid assessment and deployment of Microsoft Critical Alerts to the agency.

### Clearance

- Public Trust (SSA HQ, Woodlawn, MD) and SSBI completed (2012).
  - I am always up for a background check.

## BRANDING SIGNALS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

### Authority Signals

- Cybersecurity with deep OS hardening specialization
- 100% compliance achievement across nine technologies
- macOS hardening SME and documentation author
- Enterprise Security partnership across engineering, operations, and support teams

### Certifications & Education

- CISSP (in progress)
- Western High School, Davie, FL — Diploma (1989)
- Broward Community College, Davie, FL — Coursework